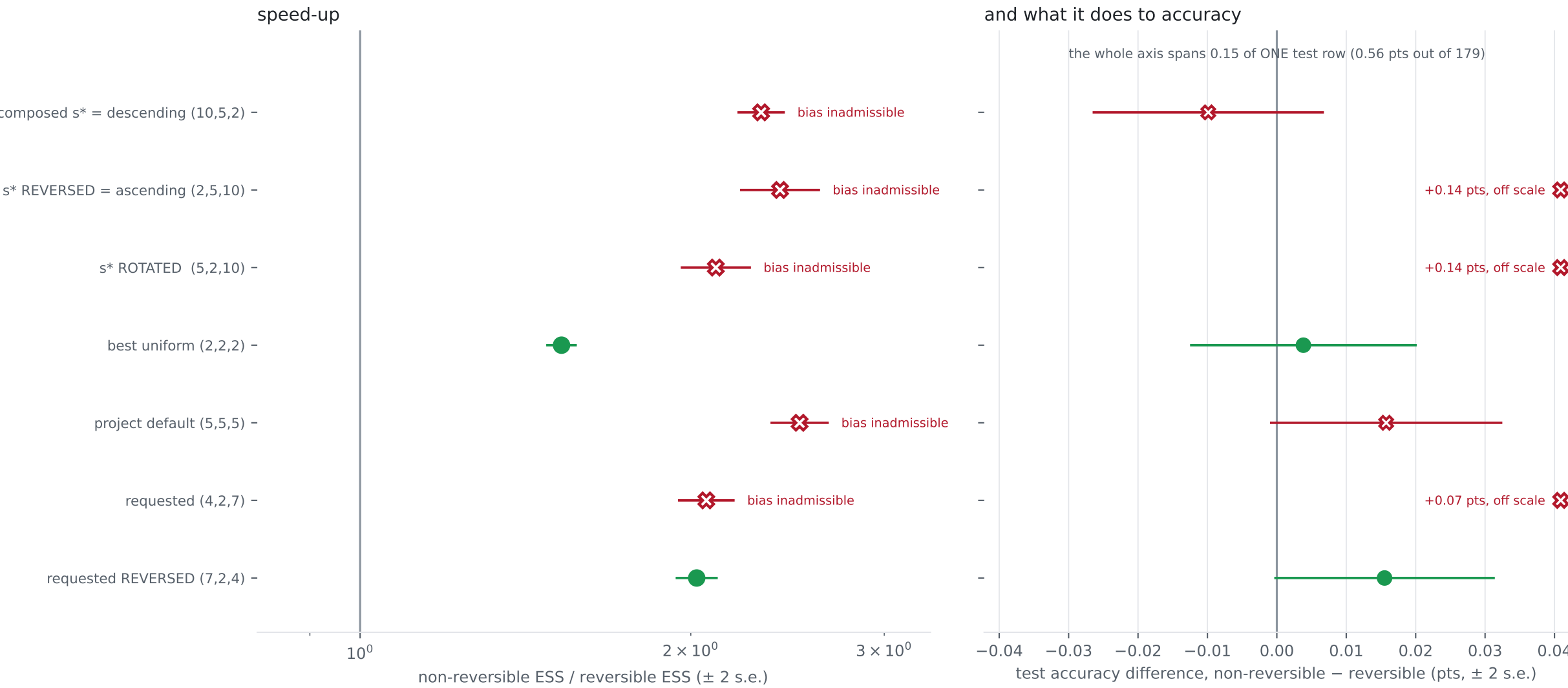


Stage C — confirmation on seed 9200, `graded` potential



R = 96 coupled chains, 16000 measured iterations, seed 9200, which took no part in the Stage A search. Filled green: the non-reversible arm's discretisation bias is within 2x the reversible arm's own, the cap declared before the search. Hollow red cross: it is not, and the speed-up on that row is bought with error rather than earned -- those rows are shown, not hidden, because they are what an unconstrained search would have returned. The REVERSED and ROTATED rows carry the identical multiset of strengths as `composed s\*` in a different order, so any difference between them is placement, not total strength. Right panel: the axis spans a fraction of ONE test row out of 179, so differences there are resolvable but not numerically meaningful; both arms provably share the invariant law, so what is plotted is finite-step bias.